

Project XTC – Development Edition 0.1

Chapter 11 v2.0 – The PLUG-IN Button and Device Mode

Pressing PLUG-IN is one of the moments where the X-Touch stops behaving like a traditional mixing surface and starts behaving like an extension of Bitwig itself. Instead of controlling track levels and pan, the controller focuses on the device chain belonging to the currently selected track.

Hardware Label and Software Function

Throughout Project XTC, hardware controls are written exactly as they appear on the X-Touch. Press PLUG-IN to enter Device Mode. The distinction is deliberate: one is the label printed on the controller, the other is the function performed by DrivenByMoss.

The Correct Sequence

Successful use of Device Mode follows the same pattern every time:

1. Press SELECT on the track you want to edit.
2. Press PLUG-IN.
3. Read the scribble strips.
4. Turn the required V-Pot.

If the wrong track is selected, Device Mode will faithfully control the wrong device.

Why Remote Controls Matter

Bitwig Remote Controls deserve careful attention because they determine how useful Device Mode becomes. A synthesiser may expose hundreds of automatable parameters, but only a handful are normally adjusted during performance. Remote Controls let you choose those important parameters and present them on the X-Touch's eight V-Pots.

Think of Remote Controls as designing your own hardware front panel. Once created, the same layout is recalled every time you load the device, making your favourite instruments feel as if they were purpose-built for the X-Touch.

Practical Example – Polymer

Load Polymer and map the first Remote Controls to Filter Cutoff, Resonance, Drive, Envelope Amount, Oscillator Shape and any other parameters you reach for regularly. Press PLUG-IN. The scribble strips should immediately display those names, while the LED rings and V-Pots reflect their current values.

Working with Third-Party Plug-ins

The same approach works with CLAP and VST3 instruments such as Serum 2 or Current. Rather than exposing every available parameter, spend a few minutes creating a sensible Remote Control page. The result is a controller layout that is easier to remember and much quicker to perform with.

Common Mistakes

I pressed PLUG-IN but nothing changed.

Check that the correct track is selected and that the selected track actually contains a device.

The parameter names are unexpected.

Review the device's Remote Control assignments.

The V-Pots seem to control the wrong instrument.

The selected track has probably changed.

Reality Check

When Device Mode appears confusing, it is almost always a matter of context rather than a software fault. Device Mode simply reflects Bitwig's current selection and Remote Control layout.

Field Note #014

Pause for a moment after pressing PLUG-IN. Reading the scribble strips before touching a V-Pot quickly becomes second nature and dramatically reduces accidental parameter changes.

Exercise

Create two instrument tracks, each with different Remote Control assignments. Move between them using SELECT, press PLUG-IN, and observe how the controller reconfigures itself. Repeat until selecting a track and entering Device Mode becomes one continuous action.

Key Takeaways

- Press PLUG-IN to enter Device Mode.
- Always select the track first.
- Remote Controls are the heart of an efficient Device Mode workflow.
- Read the scribble strips before turning a V-Pot.
- Device Mode follows Bitwig's context—it never guesses.

Before You Continue...

The next chapter explores Browser Mode and shows how DrivenByMoss lets you search, browse and load content while keeping your hands on the X-Touch.